

Delegate's Notebook

The Confederation Congress · 1786

DELEGATES

OUR STATE

DATE

Fill one box in after each vote. Two lines is plenty.

1

Paying the War Debt

NEEDS 9 OF 13

Our state voted:
YES NO ABSTAIN

Did it pass?
YES NO

CONGRESS ASKED FOR

CONGRESS ACTUALLY GOT

Congress voted yes. Why did the money still not arrive?

2

The Trade War

NEEDS 9 OF 13

Our state voted:
YES NO ABSTAIN

Did it pass?
YES NO

New York taxed goods heading to its neighbours. What could Congress actually do about it?

3

The Import Tax Amendment

NEEDS ALL 13

Our state voted:
YES NO ABSTAIN

Did it pass?
YES NO

How many states voted yes? How many were needed?

Which state or states blocked it, and why would they not agree?

4

Shays' Rebellion

NEEDS 9 OF 13

Our state voted:
YES NO ABSTAIN

Did it pass?
YES NO

CONGRESS ASKED FOR

CONGRESS ACTUALLY GOT

Armed men were marching on an arsenal. Why couldn't Congress just send an army?

What we learned

Fill this in during the debrief

1. The six weaknesses

write the round where you saw each one

WEAKNESS OF THE ARTICLES	ROUND I SAW IT	WHAT HAPPENED
Congress could not tax		
Congress could not control trade		
There was no president		
There were no national courts		
Changing the rules needed all 13		
Congress had no army		

2. What the Articles actually got right

it was not all failure

WORD BANK — USE EACH ONCE

won the war · new states · slavery · king · themselves

- a. The Articles held the country together long enough that we _____ and made peace with Britain.
- b. The Northwest Ordinance let western land become _____, equal to the original thirteen rather than ruled by them.
- c. That same law banned _____ in the whole Northwest Territory.
- d. There was no _____, and states kept the right to govern _____.

3. The two numbers that matter

CONGRESS ASKED FOR, IN TOTAL	CONGRESS ACTUALLY RECEIVED	THAT IS WHAT PERCENT?

In real life Congress asked for about \$15 million between 1781 and 1786 and received about \$2.5 million — roughly **one dollar in six**.

4. Think about it

- a. Your state probably scored well by refusing to pay. So why did the country end up worse off?

- b. If you could change one rule of this government, which one — and what problem would it fix?

Exit ticket. In one sentence: name a weakness of the Articles you felt today, and say how the Constitution fixed it.
